

Hiring Without Bias

Choosing the right people, without bias

4 psychology approaches · tips & advice — by EvaTalk

CONTENTS

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1. Before you begin
2. The 4 approaches
3. Psychodynamic lens
4. CBT lens
5. Humanistic lens
6. Systemic lens
7. Tips & advice
8. Your workbook
9. Your 4-week plan

BEFORE YOU BEGIN

Choosing the right people, without bias

Even with the best intentions, hiring is riddled with bias: a preference for what resembles us, judgments about a name, a photo, a gap in a CV. The result: we miss talent and reproduce inequalities.

This guide helps you spot your biases, move past your automatic reactions, and put a fair, effective hiring process in place.

Your intention

An upcoming hire (or a reflex you want to correct): _____

The 4 approaches

This guide works your topic through 4 complementary psychology lenses. Read, do the exercises, fill the workbook — at your own pace.

Psychodynamic — understand the root.

CBT — ease the negative thoughts.

Humanistic — reconcile with yourself.

Systemic — act on your environment.

Your biases & preferences

We spontaneously prefer what resembles us (affinity bias), and carry assumptions about a name, an origin, an age, a gender. It isn't malice: it's wiring — but it skews our choices.

Naming your biases is the condition for defusing them.

Example

Sure he was objective, Marc mostly hired profiles 'like him'. Seeing it let him broaden.

My spontaneous preferences

Which profiles put me at ease spontaneously? Which do I judge faster?

My assumptions to watch

List the 'noise' criteria (name, photo, age, CV gap) you might wrongly judge on.

→ *Naming my biases is the start of fairer hiring.*

Moving past snap judgments

'Gut feeling', 'not the right profile' (often = not like me), 'I don't feel it': these snap judgments disguise themselves as objectivity. Bringing them back to the role's real criteria corrects course.

'Gut feeling' is often a bias that doesn't know itself.

Example

Inès was about to drop a candidate 'on a feeling'. Returning to the criteria, she realized the candidate was the strongest.

Feeling or criterion?

For one application, note: my impression · what it's truly worth on the role's criteria.

Reframe

Turn 'I don't feel it' into 'what does the criteria grid say?'.

→ *Objectivity is criteria — not a feeling.*

Broadening your view of talent

Diversity is an asset: different paths and perspectives strengthen a team. Looking at potential beyond the usual codes gives more talent a chance.

Every candidate deserves a fair evaluation.

Example

By looking at potential rather than the expected 'pedigree', Léa hired a gem others had passed over.

What I truly value

Write the skills and qualities TRULY needed for the role (and those that aren't).

Broadening my pool

Where can I source more diverse profiles (channels, job-ad wording)?

→ *Broadening my view of talent means hiring better.*

A fair, concrete process

Fairness is built through process: criteria defined in advance, a common evaluation grid, standardized questions, anonymized CVs where possible, a diverse panel, and decisions based on facts.

A good process neutralizes much of the bias.

Example

By scoring each candidate on a common grid, Sofia's team stopped deciding 'on a feeling' — and hire quality rose.

My criteria grid

Define 4-6 key role criteria + a scoring scale.

My anti-bias process

Note: standardized questions · anonymization? · panel? · what I measure.

→ *A fair process neutralizes much of the bias.*

Practical tips & advice

Tips & advice

- Define criteria BEFORE seeing the applications.
- Use a common scored grid, and ask everyone the same questions.
- Anonymize CVs (name, photo, age) where possible.
- Hire in a panel: multiple views reduce individual bias.
- Beware 'gut feeling' and affinity ('they're like me').
- Broaden your sourcing channels and measure the diversity of your pool.

To fill in

My biases to watch

The bias / assumption	How I neutralize it

My criteria grid

Role criterion	Scale / score

PLAN

Your 4-week plan

Week 1 — Spot my biases & preferences.

Week 2 — Move past 'gut feeling'.

Week 3 — Broaden my view of talent.

Week 4 — Put a fair process in place.

Your plan in 3 lines

- The bias I watch:
- My key role criteria:
- My anti-bias measure (grid, panel, anonymization):

TO CLOSE

On criteria, not on feeling — you choose more fairly.

On criteria, not on feeling.

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